

Galician Gastronomic Festivals Guide 2026

Galicia is a land of traditions and, above all, of exceptional gastronomy. This guide features the most prestigious festivals of 2026 so you can plan your visit and enjoy the best products of our land.

The 12 Essential Gastronomic Festivals

1. Cambados Wine Festival (Albariño)

Where: Cambados, Pontevedra | When: Aug 4-6, 2026

The queen of Galician festivals. Three days of tastings, concerts, and markets. Saturday is the big day with the 'Great Wine Festival'.

Local Tip: Arrive early on Saturday for the best tastings and don't miss the traditional food stalls.

2. Lalín Stew Festival (Cocido)

Where: Lalín, Pontevedra | When: Feb 27 - Mar 1, 2026

Galicia's most famous stew. Thousands of servings, a gastronomic market, and a festive atmosphere.

Local Tip: Bundle up (it's cold in February) and come hungry. The Galician stew is hearty and delicious.

3. Cea Bread Festival (Pan de Cea)

Where: San Cristovo de Cea, Ourense | When: Jul 5 and Sep 4-6, 2026

Celebration of the bread with Protected Geographical Indication (PGI). Demonstrations, traditional ovens, and contests.

Local Tip: Buy bread to take home - it keeps well and is the best gastronomic souvenir.

4. O Grove Seafood Festival (Marisco)

Where: O Grove, Pontevedra | When: Oct 9-18, 2026

10 days of fresh seafood: gooseneck barnacles, velvet crabs, lobsters... All accompanied by Albariño wine.

Local Tip: Book in advance if you want to eat at the most famous restaurants. Or better: buy seafood at the market and have your own feast.

5. O Carballiño Octopus Festival (Pulpo)

Where: O Carballiño, Ourense | When: Aug 9, 2026

The oldest octopus festival in Galicia. Thousands of kilos of octopus cooked in the streets, accompanied by wine and bread.

Local Tip: Go early to avoid queues. And ask for the octopus 'á feira', which is the traditional way to eat it.

6. Arzúa Cheese Festival (Queso)

Where: Arzúa, A Coruña | When: Mar 6-8, 2026

Celebration of Arzúa-Ulloa cheese with tastings, a cheese market, and demonstrations.

Local Tip: Try the cheese with quince paste and a Ribeiro wine. Perfect combination.

7. A Coruña Empanada Festival

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Where: A Coruña | When: Jul 17-19, 2026

Contest for the best Galician empanada, workshops, and sales of all types of empanadas.

Local Tip: Try the zamburiñas (small scallops) empanada – it's a unique delicacy from the A Coruña coast.

8. Santiago Cake Festival (Tarta de Santiago)

Where: Santiago de Compostela | When: All July (especially 25th)

Throughout July, Santiago's bakeries compete for the best cake. Public tastings on July 25th.

Local Tip: Visit several bakeries to compare. The authentic one only has almond, egg, and sugar, nothing else.

9. Lacón con Grelos Festival

Where: Various towns in Lugo and Ourense | When: January-February

The star dish of the Galician winter. Gastronomic days in restaurants across Galicia with special menus.

Local Tip: It's a hearty dish, ideal for cold days. Pair it with a red wine from Ribeira Sacra.

10. Padrón Pepper Festival (Pimiento)

Where: Herbón (Padrón), A Coruña | When: First weekend of August

Celebration of the famous pepper. 'Spiciest pepper' contest, tastings, and, of course, fried peppers for everyone.

Local Tip: 'Some are hot and some are not' – it's part of the fun. Try a few to see how lucky you are.

11. Vilalba Capon Fair (Capón)

Where: Vilalba, Lugo | When: Around Dec 21

A fair with almost 200 years of tradition. Direct sale of PGI Capon, tastings, and festive atmosphere.

Local Tip: The PGI capons sell out quickly – arrive early if you want to buy one.

12. Coristanco Potato Festival (Pataca)

Where: Coristanco, A Coruña | When: Sep 19-20, 2026

Festival of Tourist Interest. Decorated tractor parade, potato sculptures, and popular sardine barbecue.

Local Tip: Try the local potatoes with grilled sardines.

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Monthly Calendar 2026

Jan-Feb	Lalín Stew, Lacón con Grelos.
March	Arzúa Cheese, Angula Festival.
April	Ribeiro Wine, Lamprea Festival.
May	Monterrei Wine, Carral Bread.
June	Valdeorras Wine, Cherry Festival.
July	A Coruña Empanada, Santiago Cake, Cea Bread (Exaltation).
August	Cambados Wine, Padrón Pepper, O Carballiño Octopus, Sardine.
September	Cea Bread (Festival), Neda Bread, Coristanco Potato, Harvest.
October	O Grove Seafood, O Rosal Wine, Chestnut, Porriño Bread.
November	Magostos (Ourense, Vila de Cruces, O Courel), Amandi Wine.
December	Vilalba Capon, Christmas Markets.

Local Tips (by Antonio)

- Arrive early: The best products run out quickly, especially at popular festivals.
- Bring cash: Many small stalls do not accept cards.
- Talk to people: Local producers love to explain their work.
- Try new things: This is your chance for unique flavors.
- Book accommodation: Especially in July and August.
- Use public transport: Avoid parking problems and save money.

Need a break? Visit us at Hamburguesería Señorís (Quiroga Palacios, Santiago). We'll be happy to chat about festivals and secret spots.